Xiaolin Zhou

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FIELDS

Energy and Environmental Economics, Industrial Organization, Applied Economics

EDUCATION

University of Massachusetts Amherst

PhD, Resource Economics — 2027 (expected)

University of Arizona

MS, Agricultural and Resource Economics — 2021

Tamkang University

BA, Industrial Economics — 2019

BBA, Finance — 2019

RESEARCH

Job Market Paper

Subsidy Pass-through and Market Power: Evidence from Production-Based Solar Subsidies. Most updated version.

> Two production-based solar subsidies in Massachusetts paid residential adopters for the electricity their systems generate: the Solar Carve-Out, through tradable certificates sold at market prices, and its successor, SMART, through a fixed rate per kWh set at approval. I build a subsidy measure for each roof from its modeled generation, which allows me to identify pass-through from differences in the subsidy across roofs installed by the same installer in the same town and year. Pass-through is about 85% in both programs. The gap that a comparison of the programs over time suggests reflects the timing of each subsidy relative to falling installation costs, not the design of the subsidy. Because variation across roofs removes the supply side from the pass-through formula, the shortfall below one bounds installer market power. Demand under SMART is log-concave, and installer markups are at most 2–4% of price at the point estimates and stay at or below about 5% even accounting for measurement error. Unlike the over-shifting found in other settings, high pass-through here points to a nearly competitive market.

Working Papers

Market Power in the New England Electricity Market: Evidence from Nuclear Refueling Outages. With Ming Ge, James Ji, and Matt Woerman.

> Uses ISO New England day-ahead data, 2016–2018. Outages raise prices $4.9/MWh; 36% of the rise is market power, a $43–45 million annual transfer from consumers.

Can Driver-Assistance Technology Offset the Vehicle-Weight Externality? With Yongjoon Park.

> Links 785,000 Massachusetts crash records to vehicle weight and safety features by VIN. Colliding with a vehicle 1,000 lb heavier raises severe-injury risk 13%; driver-assistance features are associated with a smaller effect.

TEACHING

University of Massachusetts Amherst

Instructor of Record *(Undergraduate)*

Managerial Economics — Summer 2024, 2025, 2026
Hunger in the Global Economy — Fall 2025

TA, Intro to Statistics, Industrial Organization, Public Policy in Private Market, Hunger in the Global Economy *(Undergraduate)*

TA, Statistical Inference *(Graduate)*

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, *Prof. Emily Wang, UMass Amherst* 2023

Research Assistant, *Prof. Matt Woerman, UMass Amherst* 2022

Research Assistant, *Prof. George Frisvold, University of Arizona* 2019–2021

Compliance Analyst Intern, *Haitong Securities* 2018

PRESENTATION

AERE Summer Conference, UMass Amherst Environmental Economics Reading Group, UMass Amherst IO Reading Group, UC Berkeley Summer School in Environmental and Energy Economics

AWARDS

Department Travel Grant (×3), *Resource Economics, UMass Amherst*

CALS Fellowship, *College of Agriculture and Life Sciences, University of Arizona* 2019

SKILLS

Computing: R, Python, Git, LaTeX

Language: English, Chinese (Native)

SERVICE

Graduate Student Representative, *Department Hiring Committee* 2026

Organizer, *Graduate Research Support Group* 2023

REFERENCES

Christine Crago, *Associate Professor of Resource Economics, UMass Amherst*
ccrago@resecon.umass.edu

Yongjoon Park, *Assistant Professor of Resource Economics, UMass Amherst*
yongjoonpark@umass.edu

Matt Woerman, *Assistant Professor, Colorado State University*
matt.woerman@colostate.edu